

ITI upscaling project: Plugging the skill gap

Traditional workshops are today giving way to manufacturing units that demand digital **fluency**, **competency** in data analysis, AI and robotics-related skills and the ability to work with climate-friendly engineering technologies. However, for at least a **decade**, surveys and reports have been **flagging** the **skill deficits** of the Indian workforce. Only a small **fraction** of graduates from the



Industrial Training Institutes (ITI) get placed in the **cutting-edge** economy. The deficit also means that a large **section** of the youth **lacks avenues** and support systems to realise its potential. The government's **move** to **overhaul** ITIs **was**, therefore, long overdue. Last week, the Union Cabinet approved the National Scheme for Industrial Training Institute Upgradation and **sanctioned** the **setting up** of five National Skilling Training Institutes (NSTI). The Rs 60,000-crore scheme aims to **forge** links between the technical education **ecosystem** and industry.

Established shortly after Independence, ITIs were intended to serve as vocational training centres for the **emerging** industrial sector. Today, India has close to 15,000 such institutes. Nearly 80 per cent of them came up after 2006-2007 when the National Council for Vocational Training relaxed rules, **leading to** a **mushrooming** of private ITIs. However, **abetted by** a faulty monitoring system, many **flouted** even the most basic norms. **Audits** conducted by the Directorate General of Training **revealed** that **accreditation** was granted to ITIs even while they were under construction or lacked basic safety measures. The government's **move** to restrict the new programme to 1,000 ITIs **could streamline** the system.

Twenty lakh youth will be skilled in the **revamped** ITIs over five years. By **conservative estimates**, this would **cater to** about a fifth of the **human capital** needs of industry. The ITI upscaling project should, therefore, be seen as a beginning. Several experts have argued that the **task** of schooling professionals for the smart economy **is** too **enormous** to be left to government alone. A tenth of the new programme's **costs** will be **borne** by the private sector, which has been **accorded** a more active role in designing courses and training faculty. The government must **nudge** industry towards enhancing its engagement with skill development.

[Practice Exercise]

- Red/blue coloring of words in the sentence indicates subject verb relationship; where 'red' denotes 'subject' and 'blue' denotes 'verb'.

Vocabulary

1. **Upscale** (verb) – upgrade, enhance, improve, modernize, boost उन्नत करना
2. **Plug the gap** (phrase) – fill the void, address deficiency, resolve shortfall, fix the problem, compensate कमी को पूरा करना
3. **Fluency** (noun) – proficiency, command, expertise, smoothness, articulation प्रवीणता
4. **Competency** (noun) – ability, skill, aptitude, capability, proficiency योग्यता
5. **Decade** (noun) – Period of ten year दशक
6. **Flag** (verb) – highlight, indicate, raise, signal, point out इंगित करना
7. **Skill deficit** (noun) – It refers to a lack of mastery or the inability to perform a specific skill, often due to insufficient training or practice कौशल की कमी
8. **Fraction** (noun) – part, portion, segment, section, slice – अंश
9. **Cutting-edge** (adjective) – advanced, innovative, pioneering, state-of-the-art, forefront अत्याधुनिक
10. **Avenue** (noun) – path, channel, route, way, opportunity रास्ता / अवसर
11. **Overhaul** (verb) – reform, renovate, revamp, restructure, improve पुनर्निर्माण करना
12. **Sanction** (verb) – approve, authorize, permit, endorse, allow मंजूरी देना
13. **Setting up** (noun) – establishment, initiation, foundation, launch, organization स्थापना
14. **Forge** (verb) – build, form, create, establish, develop बनाना
15. **Ecosystem** (noun) – environment, system, network, framework, structure पारिस्थितिकी तंत्र
16. **Emerging** (adjective) – developing, upcoming, rising, growing, evolving उभरता हुआ
17. **Lead** (to) (verb) – result in, cause, bring about, give rise to, trigger वजह बनना
18. **Mushrooming** (noun) – rapid growth, proliferation, expansion, spread, increase तेज़ी से वृद्धि
19. **Abet** (by) (verb) – support, aid, assist, encourage, promote सहायता देना / बढ़ावा देना
20. **Flout** (verb) – violate, defy, disregard, ignore, break उल्लंघन करना
21. **Accreditation** (noun) – certification, approval, recognition, validation, endorsement मान्यता

22. **Streamline** (verb) – simplify, systematize, organize, rationalize, modernize
सुव्यवस्थित करना

23. **Revamped** (adjective) – improved, restructured, redesigned, renovated, updated नवीनीकृत

24. **Conservative** (adjective) – (of an estimate) purposely low for the sake of caution.

25. **Estimate** (noun) – approximation, calculation, projection, evaluation, assessment अनुमान

26. **Cater** (to) (verb) – serve, provide for, meet the needs of, supply, fulfill जरूरत पूरी करना

27. **Human capital** (noun) – the skills, knowledge, and experience possessed by

an individual or population, viewed in terms of their value or cost to an organization or country. मानव पूंजी

28. **Enormous** (adjective) – huge, immense, massive, tremendous, vast बहुत बड़ा

29. **Bear the cost** (phrase) – pay, fund, finance, cover expenses, shoulder लागत उठाना

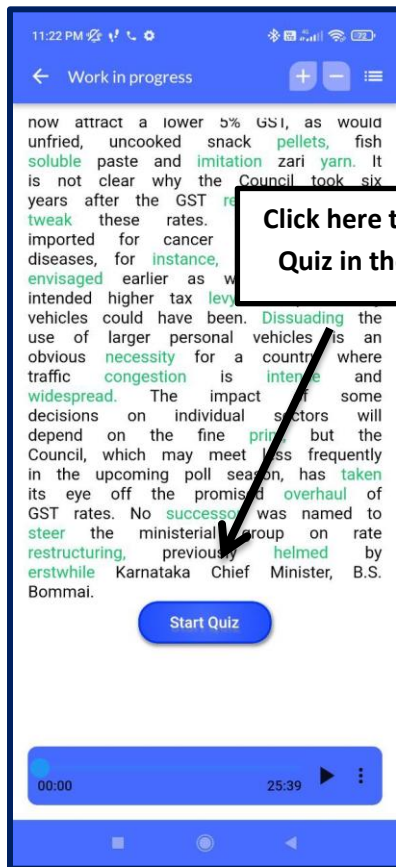
30. **Accord** (verb) – grant, give, offer, bestow, allow प्रदान करना

31. **Nudge** (verb) – encourage, push gently, prompt, motivate, stimulate प्रेरित करना / प्रोत्साहित करना

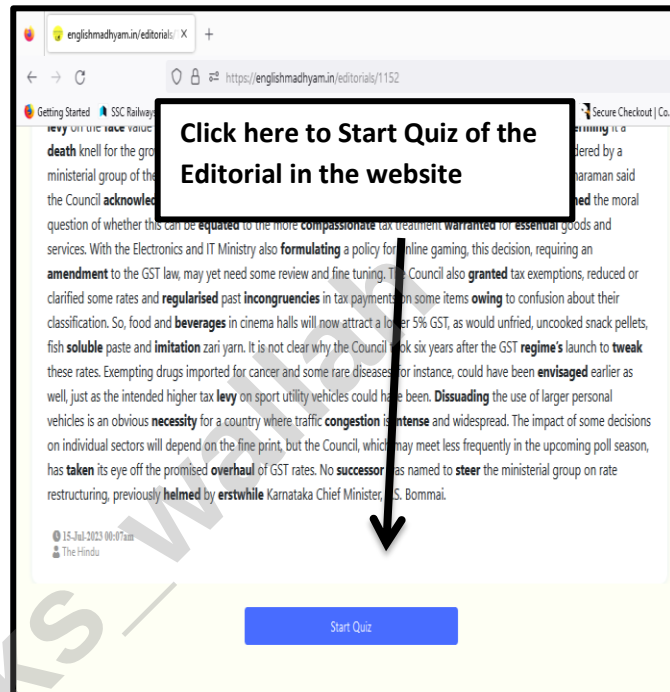
Summary of the Editorial

1. **Shifting Demands:** Modern manufacturing now requires skills in digital tools, AI, data analysis, and green technologies.
2. **Persistent Skill Gap:** Surveys for over a decade have highlighted a significant skill deficit in India's workforce.
3. **Low ITI Placement:** Only a small number of ITI graduates secure jobs in high-tech sectors.
4. **Limited Youth Opportunities:** A large section of young Indians lacks the support to unlock their potential due to poor skilling avenues.
5. **Government Initiative:** The Union Cabinet recently approved a major ITI overhaul under the National Scheme for ITI Upgradation.
6. **Financial Commitment:** A ₹60,000-crore budget has been allocated for this scheme.
7. **New Skilling Institutes:** Five National Skilling Training Institutes (NSTIs) will be set up under the scheme.
8. **Industry Linkage Goal:** The reform aims to better connect technical education with industry demands.
9. **Historical Background:** ITIs were started post-Independence for vocational training in industrial sectors.
10. **Rapid Growth Post-2006:** Nearly 80% of current ITIs were established after rules were relaxed in 2006-07, leading to unchecked expansion.
11. **Poor Regulation:** Many ITIs violated safety and quality norms due to weak oversight.
12. **Selective Implementation:** The new scheme will focus on upgrading 1,000 ITIs to improve standards.
13. **Skill Target:** The project aims to skill 20 lakh (2 million) youth over five years.
14. **Partial Coverage:** This effort will address only about 20% of industrial human capital requirements.
15. **Private Sector Role:** Industry will fund 10% of the cost and help design courses, but the government must encourage deeper private sector involvement.

Practice Exercise: Banking Pattern Based



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